
INTERNATIONAL AS ENGLISH LITERATURE

Unit 1 Aspects of Dramatic Tragedy

Tuesday 04 January 2022

07:00 GMT

Time allowed: 2 hours

Materials

For this paper you must have:

- an Oxford International AQA Examinations 12-page answer book.

Instructions

- Use black ink or black ball-point pen.
- Write the information required on the front of your answer book.
- Do all rough work in your answer book. Cross through any work you do not want to be marked.
- You must answer **one** question from Section A and **one** question from Section B.
- Remember to include, in both your answers, relevant comments on the authors' dramatic methods in the set texts you are studying.

Information

- The maximum mark for this paper is 50.
- The marks for questions are shown in brackets.
- You will be marked on your ability to:
 - use good English
 - organise information clearly
 - analyse carefully the writers' methods
 - use specialist vocabulary where appropriate.

Section A: Elizabethan and Jacobean tragedy

Answer **one** question from this section.

Either

0	1
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William Shakespeare: *Othello*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Othello, Desdemona and Iago
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 2 Scene 1**IAGO**

She that was ever fair and never proud,
Had tongue at will and yet was never loud,
Never lacked gold and yet went never gay,
Fled from her wish and yet said "Now I may";
She that being angered, her revenge being nigh,
Bade her wrong stay and her displeasure fly;
She that in wisdom never was so frail
To change the cod's head for the salmon's tail;
She that could think and ne'er disclose her mind,
See suitors following and not look behind:
She was a wight – if ever such wights were –

DESDEMONA

To do what?

IAGO

To suckle fools and chronicle small beer.

DESDEMONA

O most lame and impotent conclusion! Do not learn
of him, Emilia, though he be thy husband. How say
you, Cassio, is he not a most profane and liberal
counsellor?

CASSIO

He speaks home, madam: you may relish him more in
the soldier than in the scholar.

IAGO

(*aside*) He takes her by the palm – ay, well said, whisper! – with as little a web as this will I ensnare as great a fly as Cassio. – Ay, smile upon her, do! I will gyve thee in thine own courtship. – You say true; 'tis so, indeed. – If such tricks as these strip you out of your lieutenantry, it had been better you had not kissed your three fingers so oft, which now again you are most apt to play the sir in. – Very good, well kissed, and excellent courtesy! 'Tis so, indeed. – Yet again, your fingers to your lips? Would they were clyster-pipes for your sake!

Trumpets within

(*Aloud*) The Moor! I know his trumpet.

CASSIO

'Tis truly so.

DESDEMONA

Let's meet him and receive him.

CASSIO

Lo, where he comes!

Enter OTHELLO and attendants

OTHELLO

O my fair warrior!

DESDEMONA

My dear Othello!

OTHELLO

It gives me wonder great as my content
To see you here before me. O my soul's joy,
If after every tempest come such calms,
May the winds blow till they have wakened death,
And let the labouring bark climb hills of seas
Olympus-high, and duck again as low
As hell's from heaven. If it were now to die,
'Twere now to be most happy; for I fear
My soul hath her content so absolute
That not another comfort like to this
Succeeds in unknown fate.

DESDEMONA

The heavens forbid
But that our loves and comforts should increase
Even as our days do grow.

This extract continues on the next page

OTHELLO

Amen to that, sweet powers!
I cannot speak enough of this content;
It stops me here; it is too much of joy.

They kiss

And this, and this the greatest discords be
That e'er our hearts shall make.

IAGO

(aside) O, you are well tuned now!
But I'll set down the pegs that make this music,
As honest as I am.

There are no questions printed on this page

Turn over for the next question

or

0	2
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William Shakespeare: *King Lear*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Lear and Cordelia
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 4 Scene 7

CORDELIA

O my dear father, restoration hang
Thy medicine on my lips, and let this kiss
Repair those violent harms that my two sisters
Have in thy reverence made!

KENT

Kind and dear princess!

CORDELIA

Had you not been their father, these white flakes
Had challenged pity of them. Was this a face
To be opposed against the warring winds,
To stand against the deep dread-bolted thunder
In the most terrible and nimble stroke
Of quick cross-lightning, to watch – poor *perdu* –
With this thin helm? Mine enemy's dog,
Though he had bit me, should have stood that night
Against my fire. And wast thou fain, poor father,
To hovel thee with swine and rogues forlorn
In short and musty straw? Alack, alack,
'Tis wonder that thy life and wits at once
Had not concluded all! (*To the Doctor*) He wakes. Speak to him.

DOCTOR

Madam, do you; 'tis fittest.

CORDELIA

How does my royal lord? How fares your majesty?

KING LEAR

You do me wrong to take me out o' the grave:
Thou art a soul in bliss, but I am bound
Upon a wheel of fire, that mine own tears
Do scald like molten lead.

CORDELIA

Sir, do you know me?

KING LEAR

You are a spirit, I know. Where did you die?

CORDELIA

(To the Doctor) Still, still, far wide!

DOCTOR

He's scarce awake. Let him alone awhile.

KING LEAR

Where have I been? Where am I? Fair daylight?
I am mightily abused. I should e'en die with pity
To see another thus. I know not what to say.
I will not swear these are my hands. Let's see;
I feel this pin prick. Would I were assured
Of my condition.

CORDELIA

(Kneeling) O, look upon me, sir,
And hold your hands in benediction o'er me:
No, sir, you must not kneel.

KING LEAR

Pray, do not mock me:
I am a very foolish, fond old man,
Fourscore and upward, and, to deal plainly,
I fear I am not in my perfect mind.
Methinks I should know you, and know this man;
Yet I am doubtful, for I am mainly ignorant
What place this is; and all the skill I have
Remembers not these garments; nor I know not
Where I did lodge last night. Do not laugh at me,
For, as I am a man, I think this lady
To be my child Cordelia.

CORDELIA

And so I am.

KING LEAR

Be your tears wet? Yes, 'faith. I pray, weep not.
If you have poison for me, I will drink it.
I know you do not love me; for your sisters
Have, as I do remember, done me wrong.
You have some cause, they have not.

CORDELIA

No cause, no cause.

or

0	3
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William Shakespeare: *Hamlet*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Hamlet and Claudius
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 4 Scene 3

KING CLAUDIUS

Now, Hamlet, where's Polonius?

HAMLET

At supper.

KING CLAUDIUS

At supper? Where?

HAMLET

Not where he eats, but where he is eaten. A certain convocation of politic worms are e'en at him. Your worm is your only emperor for diet. We fat all creatures else to fat us, and we fat ourselves for maggots. Your fat king and your lean beggar is but variable service – two dishes, but to one table. That's the end.

KING CLAUDIUS

Alas, alas!

HAMLET

A man may fish with the worm that hath eat of a king, and eat of the fish that hath fed of that worm.

KING CLAUDIUS

What dost thou mean by this?

HAMLET

Nothing but to show you how a king may go a progress through the guts of a beggar.

KING CLAUDIUS

Where is Polonius?

HAMLET

In heaven; send hither to see. If your messenger find him not there, seek him i' the other place yourself. But indeed, if you find him not within this month, you shall nose him as you go up the stairs into the lobby.

KING CLAUDIUS

(to attendants) Go seek him there.

HAMLET

He will stay till you come.

Exeunt Attendants

KING CLAUDIUS

Hamlet, this deed of thine, for thine especial safety – Which we do tender as we dearly grieve For that which thou hast done – must send thee hence With fiery quickness. Therefore prepare thyself; The bark is ready, and the wind at help, The associates tend, and everything is bent For England.

HAMLET

For England?

KING CLAUDIUS

Ay, Hamlet.

HAMLET

Good.

KING CLAUDIUS

So is it, if thou knew'st our purposes.

HAMLET

I see a cherub that sees them. But come, for England! Farewell, dear mother.

KING CLAUDIUS

Thy loving father, Hamlet.

HAMLET

My mother. Father and mother is man and wife; man and wife is one flesh; and so, my mother. Come, for England!

Exit

This extract continues on the next page

KING CLAUDIUS

Follow him at foot; tempt him with speed aboard.
Delay it not; I'll have him hence to-night.
Away, for everything is sealed and done
That else leans on th' affair. Pray you, make haste.

Exeunt all but Claudius

And, England, if my love thou hold'st at aught –
As my great power thereof may give thee sense,
Since yet thy cicatrice looks raw and red
After the Danish sword, and thy free awe
Pays homage to us – thou mayst not coldly set
Our sovereign process, which imports at full,
By letters conjuring to that effect,
The present death of Hamlet. Do it, England;
For like the hectic in my blood he rages,
And thou must cure me. Till I know 'tis done,
Howe'er my haps, my joys were ne'er begun.

Exit

There are no questions printed on this page

Turn over for the next question

or

0	4
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Christopher Marlowe: *Doctor Faustus*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Faustus and Mephistopheles
- Marlowe's use of dramatic language
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 2 Scene 3

Enter Faustus in his study, and Mephistopheles

FAUSTUS

When I behold the heavens, then I repent,
And curse thee, wicked Mephistopheles,
Because thou hast deprived me of those joys.

MEPHISTOPHELES

'Twas thine own seeking, Faustus. Thank thyself.
But think'st thou heaven is such a glorious thing?
I tell thee, Faustus, it is not half so fair
As thou or any man that breathes on earth.

FAUSTUS

How prov'st thou that?

MEPHISTOPHELES

'Twas made for man; then he's more excellent.

FAUSTUS

If heaven were made for man, 'twas made for me.
I will renounce this magic and repent.

Enter the two Angels

GOOD ANGEL

Faustus, repent! Yet God will pity thee.

EVIL ANGEL

Thou art a spirit. God cannot pity thee.

FAUSTUS

Who buzzeth in mine ears I am a spirit?
Be I a devil, yet God may pity me;
Yea, God will pity me if I repent.

EVIL ANGEL

Ay, but Faustus never shall repent.

Exeunt Angels

FAUSTUS

My heart is hardened; I cannot repent.
 Scarce can I name salvation, faith, or heaven.
 Swords, poisons, halters, and envenomed steel
 Are laid before me to despatch myself;
 And long ere this I should have done the deed,
 Had not sweet pleasure conquered deep despair.
 Have not I made blind Homer sing to me
 Of Alexander's love and Oenone's death?
 And hath not he that built the walls of Thebes
 With ravishing sound of his melodious harp,
 Made music with my Mephistopheles?
 Why should I die, then, or basely despair?
 I am resolved; Faustus shall not repent.
 Come, Mephistopheles, let us dispute again
 And reason of divine astrology.
 Speak. Are there many spheres above the moon?
 Are all celestial bodies but one globe,
 As is the substance of this centric earth?

MEPHISTOPHELES

As are the elements, such are the heavens,
 Even from the moon unto the empyreal orb,
 Mutually folded in each other's spheres,
 And jointly move upon one axletree,
 Whose termine is termed the world's wide pole.
 Nor are the names of Saturn, Mars, or Jupiter
 Feigned, but are erring stars.

FAUSTUS

But have they all one motion, both *situ et tempore*?

MEPHISTOPHELES

All move from east to west in four-and-twenty hours
 upon the poles of the world, but differ in their motions upon
 the poles of the zodiac.

FAUSTUS

These slender questions Wagner can decide.
 Hath Mephistopheles no greater skill?
 Who knows not the double motion of the planets?
 That the first is finished in a natural day,
 The second thus: Saturn in thirty years, Jupiter in twelve,
 Mars in four, the sun, Venus, and Mercury in a year, the moon in
 twenty-eight days. These are freshmen's questions.

Turn over for the next question

or

0	5
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John Webster: *The Duchess of Malfi*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of the Duchess and Antonio
- Webster's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 1 Scene 1

ANTONIO

Ambition, madam, is a great man's madness,
That is not kept in chains and close-pent rooms,
But in fair lightsome lodgings, and is girt
With the wild noise of prattling visitants,
Which makes it lunatic, beyond all cure.
Conceive not I am so stupid but I aim
Whereto your favours tend; but he's a fool
That, being a-cold, would thrust his hands i' the fire
To warm them.

DUCHESS

So, now the ground's broke,
You may discover what a wealthy mine
I make you lord of.

ANTONIO

O my unworthiness!

DUCHESS

You were ill to sell yourself;
This darkning of your worth is not like that
Which tradesmen use i' th' city: their false lights
Are to rid bad wares off; and I must tell you,
If you will know where breathes a complete man
(I speak it without flattery), turn your eyes,
And progress through yourself.

ANTONIO

Were there nor heaven nor hell,
I should be honest, I have long served virtue,
And ne'er ta'en wages of her.

DUCHESS

Now she pays it.
The misery of us that are born great:
We are forced to woo, because none dare woo us;
And as a tyrant doubles with his words,
And fearfully equivocates, so we
Are forced to express our violent passions
In riddles and in dreams, and leave the path
Of simple virtue, which was never made
To seem the thing it is not. Go, go brag
You have left me heartless; mine is in your bosom,
I hope 'twill multiply love there. You do tremble:
Make not your heart so dead a piece of flesh,
To fear more than to love me. Sir, be confident;
What is 't distracts you? This is flesh and blood, sir;
'Tis not the figure cut in alabaster
Kneels at my husband's tomb. Awake, awake, man.
I do here put off all vain ceremony,
And only do appear to you a young widow
That claims you for her husband, and, like a widow,
I use but half a blush in 't.

ANTONIO

Truth speak for me:
I will remain the constant sanctuary
Of your good name.

DUCHESS

I thank you, gentle love:
And 'cause you shall not come to me in debt,
Being now my steward, here upon your lips
I sign your *Quietus est*.
(Kisses him)
This you should have begg'd now.
I have seen children oft eat sweetmeats thus,
As fearful to devour them too soon.

ANTONIO

But for your brothers?

DUCHESS

Do not think of them:
All discord, without this circumference
Is only to be pitied, and not feared;
Yet, should they know it, time will easily
Scatter the tempest.

Turn over for Section B

Section B: Later dramatic tragedies

Answer **one** question from this section.

Either

0	6
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Arthur Miller: *Death of a Salesman*

‘The tragedy of *Death of a Salesman* is driven by self-deception rather than by deception.’

Discuss this view of the play.

[25 marks]

or

0	7
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Tennessee Williams: *A Streetcar Named Desire*

‘Mitch is a weak and ultimately inadequate figure. He has little impact on the tragedy of *A Streetcar Named Desire*.’

How far do you agree with this view of the way that Mitch is presented in the play?

[25 marks]

or

0	8
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Henrik Ibsen: *Hedda Gabler*

‘Hedda cannot cope with reality. That is her tragedy.’

To what extent do you agree with this view of the way that Hedda is presented in the tragedy of *Hedda Gabler*?

[25 marks]

or

0	9
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Samuel Beckett: *Waiting for Godot*

‘The relationship between Vladimir and Estragon is central to the tragedy of *Waiting for Godot*.’

To what extent do you agree with this view of the play?

[25 marks]

or

1	0
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Brian Friel: *Translations*

'*Translations* is a tragedy about characters who are trapped within a place and a time.'

Discuss this view of the play.

[25 marks]

END OF QUESTIONS

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